Document 2: Investment Process and Investment Licensing

This document walks an investor through the steps of setting up and licensing a business in Uganda, from company registration to the UIA investment licence. Most of these services can now be accessed online through the eBiz platform (see Document 3).

Step 1 - Register Your Company: Register the company with the Uganda Registration Services Bureau (URSB) to obtain a Certificate of Incorporation. Company registration services are available at the Investor One-Stop Centre. The registration form used is Form S18 (Registration of Company). The Registrar issues the certificate of registration within two working days. The published registration fee for a company limited by guarantee is UGX 80,000. Fees change, so confirm the current schedule with URSB.

Step 2 - Register for Tax: Obtain a Tax Identification Number (TIN) from the Uganda Revenue Authority (URA). Applications can be processed at any URA office, including the Investor One-Stop Centre, or online through the URA website. A non-individual TIN registration form applies to companies.

Step 3 - Apply for the Investment Licence: UIA issues the Investment Licence to both domestic and foreign companies. The licence is free of charge and is issued within 48 hours if the application meets the criteria. Applications are made online through the eBiz portal. A checklist of the documents required for an Investment Licence is available in the UIA Download Centre (see Document 7).

Step 4 - Complete Sector-Specific Registrations: Depending on the business, register with the relevant professional or regulatory agency and obtain any other licences or permits needed, such as a trading licence from Kampala Capital City Authority (KCCA) or environmental clearance from the National Environment Management Authority (NEMA).

Who Is Eligible for an Investment Licence: A company is eligible after it has been incorporated in Uganda and meets the capital thresholds:

- Foreign firms: capital investment must exceed US$ 250,000.
- Domestic firms: capital investment must exceed US$ 50,000.

Why the Licence Matters: The investment licence is the document that connects an investor to UIA's facilitation services and to the incentives described in Document 5. The legal basis for the licensing regime is explained in Document 4.

After You Are Licensed: UIA provides aftercare services to licensed investors and monitors licensed projects. Licensed projects may be asked to complete UIA's project monitoring questionnaire, which is available in the Download Centre.

Important Note on Older Guides: Older UIA materials, such as the June 2015 Brief Guide to Investing in Uganda, quote a lower capital threshold of US$ 100,000 for foreign firms. Use the current thresholds above and see Document 8 for a list of outdated sources.

If you are unsure which step applies to your business, UIA's One-Stop Centre team and the eBiz help desk can guide you. Contact details are in Documents 1 and 3.

Sources: UIA Getting Started page (ugandainvest.go.ug/getting-started); UIA Investor Facilitation page; UIA Download Centre; UIA Brief Guide to Investing in Uganda (June 2015, superseded). Last verified: 21 October 2026.